his own right, and not because he was someone's "man"—Golda's or his patron's from his Palmach days, Yigal Allon. Rabin needed a period of calm without any tremors, in the political arena as well as in the military. The man whom he saw as someone he could lean on was the director of the Mossad, Zvi Zamir, a friend from his time in the Palmach, who had stood by Golda throughout the war and who had come out of the war and the Agranat Commission relatively unscathed. Rabin wanted him by his side as a special intelligence adviser to the prime minister. Zamir was prepared to consider this proposal but suggested that the prime minister appoint a committee whose role would be to examine a range of issues related to the organization of the intelligence community in the post–Yom Kippur War era and to present recommendations for changes and improvements.

Such a committee was appointed on April 26, 1974. Its members were Zvi Zamir, who served as its chairman; Mordechai Gazit, director general of the Prime Minister's Office; Major General Shlomo Gazit, head of Military Intelligence; Yossef Harmelin, head of the Shin Bet; and Avraham Kidron, director general of the Foreign Ministry. The committee's mandate was to submit recommendations regarding the organization of the intelligence community, including:

1. The delineation of areas of activity and responsibilities between the research departments of the General Staff/Military Intelligence, the Mossad, the Ministry of Foreign Affairs, and the Shin Bet
2. Methods for the dissemination of information from the collection units to the research units, the distribution of assessment papers among the assessment bodies, and the distribution of assessments from the assessment bodies to the decision-making parties
3. The authority and modus operandi of the special adviser for intelligence to the prime minister, as recommended by the Agranat Commission

The rationale that guided Zamir in his response to Rabin's request was that a door was opening for him to be the one to establish the recommendations of the Agranat Commission and turn the intelligence community into a pluralistic organism. From the mandate that was given to the Zamir Committee, one can see that Zamir did not limit himself to shaping the role of the prime minister's intelligence adviser but rather sought